

Philipp Hilbert. *Data and API product leader with a systems builder's instinct.*

Positioning, ten years shipping data platforms and APIs in regulated, ambiguous environments – now applying that to carbon intelligence.

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§ WHY CLIMATIQ

Climatiq sits at an intersection I find genuinely compelling: the hard technical problem of emissions data quality and provenance, delivered through an API that thousands of engineering teams depend on for accurate calculations. The job description names close collaboration with LCA and carbon accounting experts on methodology development – that is the kind of cross-disciplinary product work I have done across defence AI platforms and public data analytics, where domain correctness is non-negotiable and the PM is the bridge between scientists and shipping code. The API and data layer you are building is foundational infrastructure, not a feature surface – the same architecture-first thinking I brought to the Arbeitsmarktmonitor and the FCAS data platform. *That is exactly the environment where methodical, low-ego product work compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked inside a sustainability or climate tech company before, so the specific vocabulary of carbon accounting, emission factors, and LCA methodology is new to me rather than lived. What I do bring is eight years of shipping data platforms where scientific correctness and auditability were the product – provenance, data lineage, reproducible transformation pipelines – and the habits of a PM who treats domain experts as the primary source of truth during discovery.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, doc drafting
- **Cursor / VSCode**, LLM-assisted development
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy mockups and interactive wireframes
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **GitHub Copilot**, continuous in-editor assistance

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Helm, OpenShift, Jenkins, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, AngularJS, REST APIs, GitOps pipelines, Redpanda, MicroStrategy, Docker, Bitbucket, Git.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CLIMATIQ

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with the data engineers and climate scientists, read every open API spec and data quality ticket, and map where the emission calculation pipeline breaks or where customers push back – the gaps in coverage, the methodology edge cases, the integration friction points named in support channels.

WEEK 2

Slice and prioritise.

Turn the gap map into a ranked backlog with explicit rationale: customer impact, methodology risk, integration blocker – then align it with the CTO and commercial team before a single sprint is touched.

Ship and close loops.

Drive the first customer-facing improvement through to release, close the feedback loop with the platform partner or enterprise customer who surfaced it, and use that cycle to calibrate how fast and how accurately the team can move.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Climatiq team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Manager, Data and API role because the product problem is one I have been solving, under different labels, for nearly a decade: how do you build a data platform that domain experts trust, that engineers can integrate reliably, and that holds up under regulatory and scientific scrutiny? At Climatiq, that question has a concrete answer with real-world consequence – every emission factor served through the API either advances or undermines a corporate climate commitment. That stakes profile is one I take seriously.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned the data management platform for the FCAS defence programme – a context where data provenance, reproducibility, and auditability were not nice-to-haves but contractual requirements. I introduced transformation pipelines with full audit trails, implemented SafeAI and ExplainableAI concepts alongside data scientists, and delivered features end-to-end including user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, and GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD. That experience maps directly to what Climatiq needs from a PM who partners with LCA experts on methodology development: the discipline to track where data comes from, what transformation was applied, and how to surface that transparently to the end user.

At the Federal Employment Agency, I owned the Arbeitsmarktmonitor analytics platform – a public-facing data product consumed by policymakers and regional planners who needed to trust what they saw. I introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, worked with dbt and DuckDB for data modelling, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer with responsibility for compliance and data lineage. Managing a data product where the underlying calculations are scrutinised by expert users is the same discipline as managing an emissions database where climate scientists and corporate sustainability teams need to rely on the numbers. I know how to hold that trust while still shipping.

On the API side, I have worked across integration-heavy products throughout my career – from CGM hospital information system integrations at CLINET Platforms to REST API design in InsurTech at Emil Group – and I understand that an API product is not just an endpoint but a contract with the developers who build on top of it. Versioning discipline, clear error semantics,

backward compatibility, and integration documentation are product decisions, not just engineering ones.

I am Berlin-based, an EU citizen, and available on four weeks' notice. I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to where Climatiq's data and API platform is heading.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience owning data platforms, APIs, and integration-heavy systems in regulated and scientifically demanding environments. At Rohde & Schwarz, owned an AI and data management platform for a multinational defence programme where provenance, auditability, and reproducibility were contractual. At the Federal Employment Agency, shipped an analytics platform used by policymakers, with responsibility for ETL automation, data lineage, and IT security compliance. Comfortable bridging climate scientists and carbon accounting experts with engineering teams, holding scientific correctness and delivery cadence simultaneously.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Data platform product ownership with provenance and auditability discipline
- API and integration product design in B2B SaaS and PaaS contexts
- Cross-functional alignment with domain experts and engineering leads
- ETL pipeline design and data quality product thinking
- End-to-end feature delivery from discovery through GitOps rollout
- Sprint discipline, backlog management, and team restructuring
- Customer empathy in regulated, expert-user B2B environments
- Technical fluency across Python, SQL, Kubernetes, REST APIs
- Founder-level pragmatism, low ego, high agency

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned a central AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets (image, audio, tabular) within the FCAS European defence programme
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible data transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent evaluation concepts (SafeAI, ExplainableAI)
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA

Tech: Kotlin, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, OpenShift

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Advanced the Arbeitsmarktmonitor, an analytics platform for regional labour market and demographic data consumed by policymakers and regional planners
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; worked with dbt and DuckDB for data modelling
- Delivered new features including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with focus on compliance, governance, and data lineage
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

Tech: Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Kubernetes, Jenkins

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned product for a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline; split a 17-person team into focused Scrum units with ownership and deputy concepts
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops

Tech: Low-code platform, Java, HTML/CSS, Kubernetes, REST APIs

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered a mobile-first pilot app for hospitals across iOS and Android: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, patient document storage
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows
- Built stakeholder trust through transparent communication of legacy API constraints and external database complexity

Tech: AngularJS, Ionic, Python, Kubernetes, CGM API integration

BUNDESDRUCKEREI 2021, 2021

Product Owner, COVID-19 Data Platform

- Owned two RKI projects (DIM and DESH): secure data structures and identity management for national COVID-19 reporting infrastructure
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AOK HEALTH INSURANCE ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Led migration of internal webshop to Shopware, including complex catalogue and API integration and customisable approval policies
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§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- USP: setup under two minutes, no technical knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer alongside product ownership

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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